

✂ A helper (not the host) cuts these out. Gold-framed cards go to the Guest of Honor.



EVIDENCE #1

OLD

A 2016 Staff Photo

A framed photo packed in Cece's luggage: the Marchbanks Weddings team, summer 2016. Third from the left, holding a clipboard, is a young Blair Ashdown. On the back, in Cece's handwriting: "B.A. Let go in June. Missed one deadline. Never again."

BLUEBELL LAKE INN



EVIDENCE #2

OLD

A Canceled Cake Contract

A contract between Marchbanks Weddings and Calloway Cakes, three years old, stamped CANCELED. Cece's note in the margin: "Cake late. Deposit of \$4,000 kept." Underneath, in a different pen: "It was NOT late. Wrong address."

BLUEBELL LAKE INN



EVIDENCE #3

OLD

A 2019 Magazine Column

A yellowed clipping of Cece's column, "Lakeside Venues to Avoid." Number one: Bluebell Lake Inn, "damp, dated, and run by an owner who argues." It was found folded small in the inn's office drawer, with one word penciled across the top: "Remember."

BLUEBELL LAKE INN



EVIDENCE #4

OLD

★ GUEST OF HONOR CLUE · READ ALOUD

My Grandmother's Teacup

"Everyone, listen closely..."

This blue teacup has been in my family for three generations. At 3:00, Blair and I unpacked it and set it on the tea room side table. I looked inside: clean, empty and dry. Then we walked down to the dock. At 3:30, Emerson poured Cece's chamomile into it, as Cece had asked at lunch.

FOR THE GUEST OF HONOR



EVIDENCE #5

NEW

The Doctor's Note

From Dr. Ames, the village doctor: "Ms. Marchbanks took heart drops on prescription. The whole bottle was in the blue teacup. The teapot, honey jar and other cups are clean. No plant was involved. The drops had dried into a film on the bottom, so they went into the empty cup at least ten minutes before the tea was poured."

BLUEBELL LAKE INN



EVIDENCE #6

NEW

The Florist's Order Sheet

Dakota Lane's order for the weekend: cornflowers, white roses, blue hydrangeas and twelve foxglove spires for the tall vases. A note in the margin: "Foxglove is toxic. Keep away from kids, pets and food tables." The foxglove vases stand in the lobby and on the terrace.

BLUEBELL LAKE INN



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EVIDENCE #7

NEW

Photos on a Memory Card

Found under the tea room window seat: a camera memory card. It holds nine photos of the blue teacup on its saucer, timed 3:12 to 3:18 pm. In the first, the cup is empty and dry. In the sixth (3:16), an amber dropper bottle stands beside the saucer. Through the window, Dakota kneels in the flower bed in every photo.

BLUEBELL LAKE INN



EVIDENCE #8

NEW

★ GUEST OF HONOR CLUE · READ ALOUD

Cece's Heart Drops

"Here is what I remember..."

At lunch, Cece held up a little amber bottle and laughed: "Two drops a day, doctor's orders." Cece kept it in the inside pocket of that cream handbag. At 3:00 the handbag was hanging on a tea room chair. At 3:40, Cece reached into that pocket for the drops. The bottle was gone.

FOR THE GUEST OF HONOR



EVIDENCE #9

BORROWED

The Empty Bottle

Pushed deep into the cornflower arrangement on the tea room side table: Cece's amber dropper bottle, empty. The label reads "C. Marchbanks, two drops daily." It is wrapped in a plain gray microfiber cloth, the kind used to clean glasses and camera lenses. The bottle has been wiped clean.

BLUEBELL LAKE INN



EVIDENCE #10

BORROWED

Cece's Planner

The last written page of Cece's leather planner: "SUNDAY, after brunch: tell everyone who has been selling my clients' private wedding photos to the gossip pages. Every leaked photo was taken from spots where only my hired photographer is allowed. Last chance to confess: Saturday night."

BLUEBELL LAKE INN



EVIDENCE #11

BORROWED

The Borrowed Sign

The front desk book reads: "3:08 pm. 'Private Session' sign borrowed. For photos." No name is written. The brass sign says "Private Session. Please Do Not Enter." At 3:30 it was found lying on the tea room window seat, inside the room, instead of hanging on the door.

BLUEBELL LAKE INN



EVIDENCE #12

BORROWED

★ GUEST OF HONOR CLUE · READ ALOUD

On the Garden Path

"One last thing..."

At 3:25, Blair and I left the dock and walked up the garden path. Dakota was kneeling in the cornflower bed. At 3:27, Finley came out of the tea room's garden doors and said, "Just came up from the boathouse. Gorgeous light down there." Blair and I had been beside that boathouse since 3:05. Nobody came near it.

FOR THE GUEST OF HONOR



Card Backs

OPTIONAL · PRINT ON THE BACK

Optional: print on the back of pages 1 and 2 so cards can be cut face down.



 EVIDENCE <i>The Something Blue Murder</i>	 EVIDENCE <i>The Something Blue Murder</i>
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